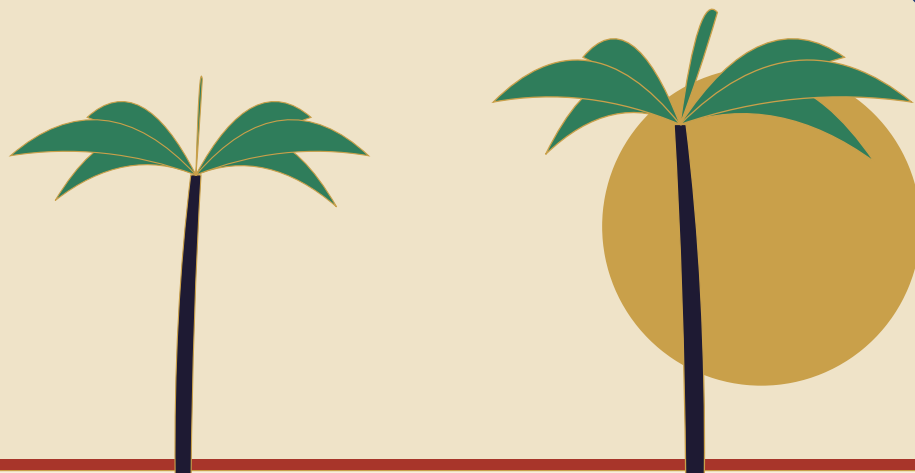


NOOR POST

One of fourteen. Open it on the day.



FOR

[Child's name]



Noor Post

[Return address — not set]

ENVELOPE 05 • JUMADA AL-
AWWAL • INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

🕒 **About twenty-five minutes**

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The prints
- 4 Talk about it
- 5 The stickers
- 6 The postcard

FACT PANEL

Imam Muhammad al-Baqir

(peace be upon him)

B. 57 AH, MEDINA • D. 114 AH, MEDINA

- **Where and when.** Medina, nearly all of it. He was at Karbala as a small child and went back, and afterwards did not travel much — for the first time in four generations, the family was left largely alone.
- **Who was ruling.** The Umayyad caliphs, from Damascus, and there were several in his lifetime. The empire had grown so fast it was busy holding itself together, which is the closest thing to peace the family had had.
- **The imamate.** About nineteen years, from 95 AH, from the age of about thirty-eight.
- **What he left.** Named students, and a method. Zurara ibn A'yan, Muhammad ibn Muslim, Abu Basir and others were taught in his circle and taught in turn. **He is the point where the answers start being written down instead of remembered.**
- **Zaynab.** Her birth is kept on the 5th of this month, and her shrine outside Damascus is where people go. She was the one who came back from Karbala and made sure it was told — the boy in this letter grew up in a house where she was doing that.
- **Elsewhere in the world.** In the same years, in the north of England, a monk called Bede was finishing a history of his own people — writing things down, in a cold monastery, for exactly the same reason.

He died in Medina in 114 AH. Shia accounts hold that he was killed on the orders of Hisham ibn Abd al-Malik.

The Small Boy on That Ground



● is the grown-up • ○ is you • ●○ is together

- There was a child at Karbala. Not one of the ones people usually name. A boy of about four, holding somebody's hand in the tents, too small to be asked anything and too small to be sent away.

○ **Four?**

- About four. Old enough to remember it. Not old enough to understand it while it was happening — that comes later, in pieces, over years, the way it does.
- He walked out of it with what was left of the family. He grew up. He got old enough to be asked things, and then old enough to be asked everything, and by the time he was a grown man in Medina there were people at his door most mornings.

○ **Asking what?**

- Anything. How to treat a neighbour. What a promise is worth. Whether a thing they had heard was true, and who had said it, and whether that person had been there. And he would answer, and somebody sitting at the side would write it down.

○ **Did people write it down before him?**

- Not much, and not carefully. Things were remembered rather than recorded, and remembering is a good system right up until the people doing it die. He started the other thing. His son finished it.

○ Where did he learn all of it?

● From his father, who had been at Karbala too, and from his grandmother, and from what he had seen with his own eyes when he was four years old and nobody thought he was watching.

○ Would you rather remember something or write it down? Say which now.

● His name is a description. Al-Baqir means the one who splits something open — the way you split a fruit to see the inside of it, or split open ground to see what is under it. That is what people called him for what he did with a question.

● Here is the part that almost nobody puts together. The man who started the writing down, whose school went on to have hundreds of students in it, whose answers are still being read in this room — he had been a small boy standing on that ground.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

●○

He was four. He was there. He remembered.



Then the hadith card.



IMAM AL-BAQIR SAID

“No mixture is better than the
mixture of clemency and
knowledge.”

Imam al-Baqir



NOOR POST · THE FOURTEEN

The chain

Every card in this box is one link. Lay all fourteen in order and the chain runs from the Prophet to the last of the twelve, each one passing on what was given.



Fourteen segments · historical order

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims, no. 2. Translated by Badr Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

Talk about it

About ten minutes. No right answers, and no points.

2

• Grown-up answers this one first.

What is the oldest thing you remember, and how much of it do you think you have got wrong?

3

Before him, people mostly remembered things instead of writing them down. Name one thing in this house that only works because somebody wrote it down.

TURN OVER →

TALK ABOUT IT • CONTINUED

4

He was called *the one who splits things open*. If people named you for the thing you do most, what would they call you?

5

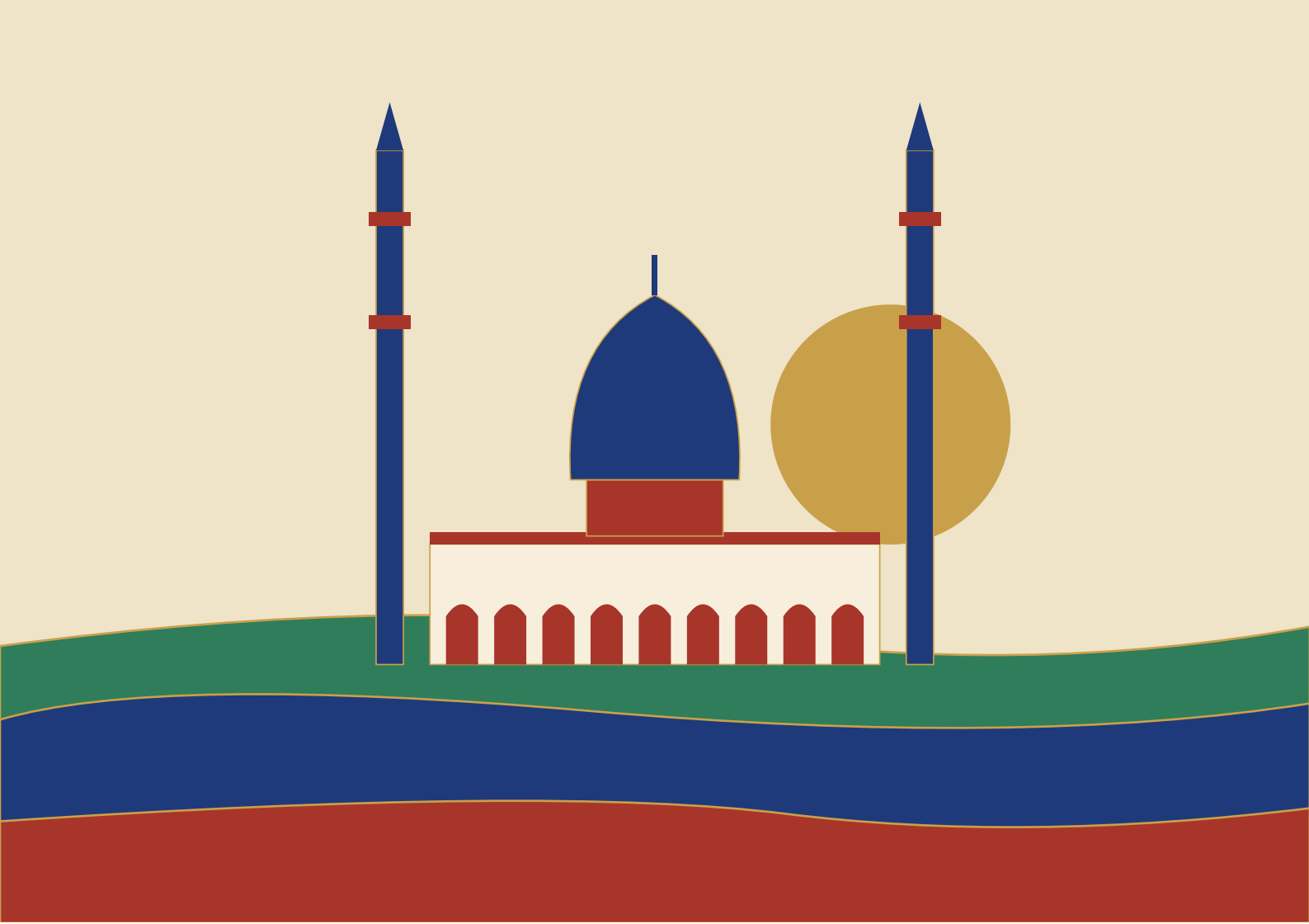
▮ **This one is hard for a grown-up.**

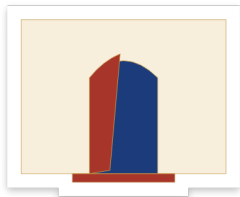
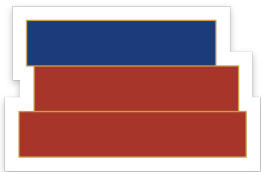
He learned most of it from people who had been there.
Who did you learn yours from, and did you ever check it?

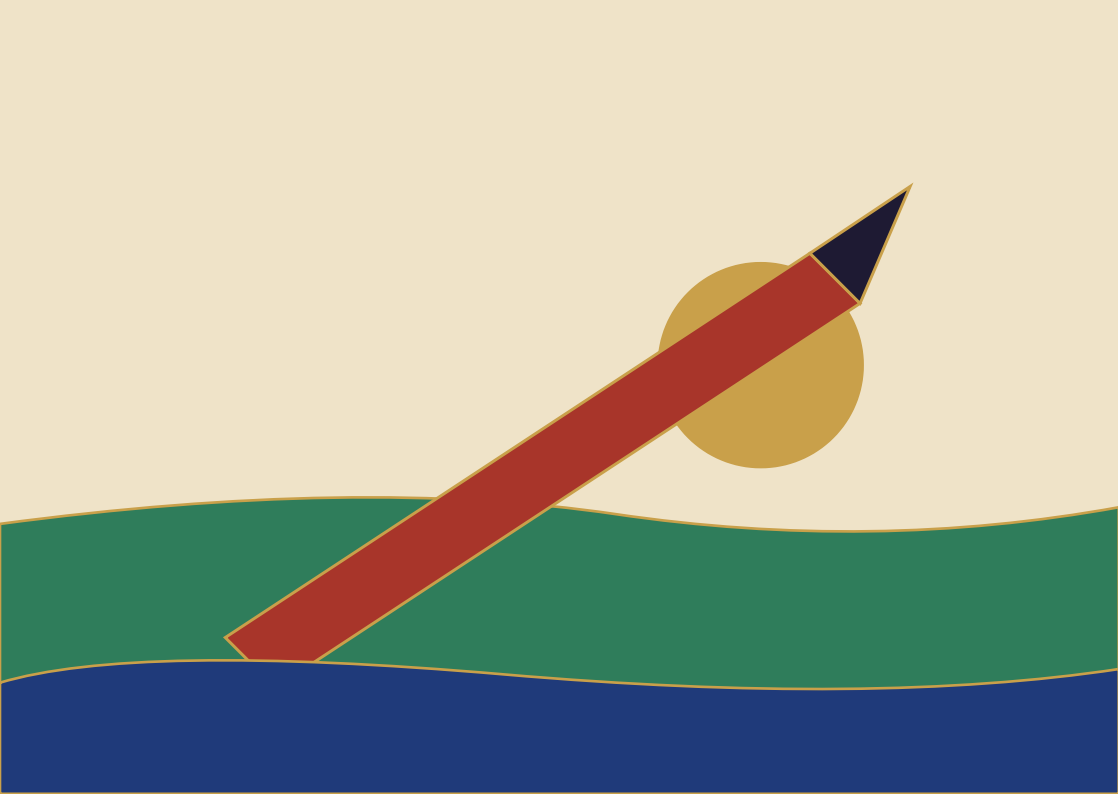
LAST

Both of you write down one thing that happened this week. Compare them next Jumada al-Awwal.









We opened this one together.

● _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]

